

2022 FIFA World Cup

The **2022 FIFA World Cup** was the 22nd FIFA World Cup, the quadrennial world championship for national football teams organised by FIFA. It took place in Qatar from 20 November to 18 December 2022, after the country was awarded the hosting rights in 2010. It was the first World Cup to be held in the Middle East and the Arabian Peninsula, and the second in an Asian country after the 2002 tournament in South Korea and Japan.^[A]

This tournament was the last with 32 participating teams, with the number of teams being increased to 48 for the 2026 World Cup. To avoid the extremes of Qatar's hot and humid climate in summers,^[1] the event was held in November and December, becoming the first one to take place in the end of the year and outside the traditional months of May, June, and July.^{[1][2]} It was held over a reduced time frame of 29 days with 64 matches played in eight venues across five cities. Qatar entered the event—their first World Cup—automatically as the host's national team, alongside 31 teams determined by the qualification process.

Morocco made history by becoming the first African nation to reach the semi-final of a World Cup, falling short 0–2 against France.^[3] Argentina were crowned the champions after winning the final against the title holder France 4–2 on penalties following a 3–3 draw after extra time. It was Argentina's third title and their first since 1986. Argentina were the first nation from outside of Europe to win the tournament since 2002. French player Kylian Mbappé became the first player to score a hat-trick in a World Cup final since Geoff Hurst in the 1966 final and won the Golden Boot as he scored the most goals (eight) during the tournament. Mbappé also became the first player to score in two consecutive finals since Vavá of Brazil did the same in 1958 and 1962.

Argentine captain Lionel Messi was voted the tournament's best player, winning his second Golden Ball. The tournament has been considered exceptionally poetic as the capstone of his career, with the win fulfilling for some commentators a previously unmet criterion to be regarded as the greatest player of all time.^[4] Teammates Emiliano Martínez and Enzo Fernández won the Golden Glove, awarded to the tournament's best goalkeeper, and the Young Player Award, awarded to the tournament's best young player, respectively. With 172 goals, the tournament set a record for the highest number of goals scored in the 32-team format, with every participating team scoring at least one goal.

The choice to host the World Cup in Qatar attracted significant criticism, with concerns raised over the country's treatment of migrant workers, women, and members of the LGBTQ+ community, as well as Qatar's climate, lack of a strong football culture, scheduling changes, and allegations of bribery for hosting rights and wider FIFA corruption.^[B]

Format

The FIFA World Cup is a professional football (soccer) tournament held between national football (soccer) teams, organised by FIFA.^{[13][14]} The tournament, held every four years, was first played in 1930 in Uruguay,^[15] and has been contested by 32 teams since the 1998 event.^[15] The tournament was contested with eight round-robin groups followed by a knockout round for 16 teams.^[16] The defending champions were France, who defeated Croatia 4–2 in the 2018 FIFA World Cup Final.^{[17][18]} The event

2022 FIFA World Cup

كأس العالم لكرة القدم 2022



FIFA WORLD CUP
Qatar 2022

Tournament details

Host country

Qatar

Dates

20 November – 18 December

Teams

32 (from 5 confederations)

Venue

8 (in 5 host cities)

Final positions

Champions

 Argentina (3rd title)

Runners-up

 France

Third place

 Croatia

Fourth place

 Morocco

Tournament statistics

Matches played

64

Goals scored

172 (2.69 per match)

Attendance

3,404,252 (53,191 per match)

Top scorer

 Kylian Mbappé (8 goals)

Best player

 Lionel Messi

Best young player

 Enzo Fernández

Best goalkeeper

 Emiliano Martínez

Fair play award

 England

← 2018

2026 →

was scheduled to take place under a reduced length,^[19] from 20 November to 18 December in Qatar.^{[20][21][22]} Being held in Qatar, it was the first World Cup tournament to be held in the Arab world.^[23] Spectators were not required to follow most COVID-19 restrictions such as social distancing, wearing masks, and negative tests.^[24]

Schedule

Unlike previous FIFA World Cups, which are typically played in June and July, because of Qatar's intense summer heat and often fairly high humidity,^{[1][21][25]} the 2022 World Cup was played in November and December.^{[5][26]} As a result, the World Cup was unusually staged in the middle of the seasons of many domestic association football leagues, which started in late July or August, including all of the major European leagues, which had been obliged to incorporate extended breaks into their domestic schedules to accommodate the World Cup. Major European competitions had scheduled their respective competitions group matches to be played before the World Cup, to avoid playing group matches the following year.^[27]

The match schedule was confirmed by FIFA on 15 July 2020.^[28] The group stage was set to begin on 21 November, with four matches every day. Later, the schedule was tweaked by moving the Qatar vs Ecuador game to 20 November, after Qatar lobbied FIFA to allow their team to open the tournament.^{[29][30][31]} The final was played on 18 December 2022, National Day, at Lusail Stadium.^{[28][32]} Unlike previous tournaments where the match venues and kick-off times for each fixture were set prior to the draw, the assignment of group fixtures for each matchday to a specific venue and kick-off time was only made after the final draw, with the teams of each specific fixture known. This was due to the close proximity of the venues, which allowed the organisers to optimise stadium allocation for spectators and kick-off times for television audiences.^[28]

The matches for each group were allocated to the following stadiums:^[32]

- Groups A, B, E, F: Al Bayt Stadium, Khalifa International Stadium, Al Thumama Stadium, Ahmad bin Ali Stadium
- Groups C, D, G, H: Lusail Stadium, Stadium 974, Education City Stadium, Al Janoub Stadium

FIFA confirmed the group stage venue and kick-off times on 1 April 2022, following the draw.^{[33][34]}

Prize money

In April 2022, FIFA announced the prizes for all participating nations. Each qualified team received \$1.5 million before the competition to cover preparation costs with each team receiving at least \$9 million in prize money. This edition's total prize pool was \$440 million, \$40 million greater than the prize pool of the previous tournament.^[35]

Place	Teams	Amount (in millions)	
		Per team	Total
Champions	1	\$42	\$42
Runners-up	1	\$30	\$30
Third place	1	\$27	\$27
Fourth place	1	\$25	\$25
5th–8th place (quarter-finals)	4	\$17	\$68
9th–16th place (round of 16)	8	\$13	\$104
17th–32nd place (group stage)	16	\$9	\$144
Total	32	\$440	

Rule changes

The tournament featured new substitution rules whereby teams could make up to five substitutions in normal time, and an additional substitution in extra time.^{[36][37][38]} In addition, it was the first World Cup to feature concussion substitutions, whereby each team was permitted to use a maximum of one concussion substitute during a match. A concussion substitution did not count towards a team's quota of regular substitutions.^[39] Iranian goalkeeper Alireza Beiranvand suffered a concussion in his country's opening match against England and was replaced by Hossein Hosseini. This was the first use of a dedicated concussion substitute during a World Cup.^[40]

Host selection

The bidding procedure to host the 2018 and 2022 FIFA World Cups began in January 2009. National associations had until 2 February 2009 to register interest.^[41] Initially, 11 bids were made for the 2018 FIFA World Cup, but Mexico withdrew from proceedings,^{[42][43]} and Indonesia's bid was rejected by FIFA in February 2010 after the Indonesian Football Association failed to submit a letter of Indonesian government guarantee to support the bid.^[44]

After UEFA were guaranteed to host the 2018 event, members of UEFA were no longer in contention to host in 2022.^[45] There were five bids remaining for the 2022 FIFA World Cup: Australia, Japan, Qatar, South Korea, and the United States. The 22-member FIFA Executive Committee convened in Zürich, Switzerland, on 2 December 2010 to vote to select the hosts of both tournaments.^{[46][47]} Two FIFA executive committee members were suspended before the vote in relation to allegations of corruption regarding their votes.^[48] The decision to host the 2022 World Cup in Qatar, which was graded as having "high operational risk",^[49] generated criticism from media commentators.^[50] It was criticised by many as being part of the FIFA corruption scandals,^[51] which led to the 2015 FIFA corruption case.

The voting patterns were as follows:^[52]

2022 FIFA bidding (majority 12 votes)

Bidders	Votes			
	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Round 4
Qatar	11	10	11	14
United States	3	5	6	8
South Korea	4	5	5	Eliminated
Japan	3	2	Eliminated	
Australia	1	Eliminated		

Cost of hosting the tournament

At an estimated cost of over \$220 billion,^[53] it is the most expensive World Cup ever held to date; this figure is disputed by Qatari officials, including organising CEO Nasser Al Khater, who said the true cost was \$8 billion, and other figures related to overall infrastructure development since the World Cup was awarded to Qatar in 2010.^[54]

Venues

The first five proposed venues for the World Cup were unveiled at the beginning of March 2010. Qatar intended that the stadiums should reflect its history and culture, and for the designs to meet the following terms of reference: legacy, comfort, accessibility, and sustainability.^[55] The stadiums were equipped with cooling systems that aim to reduce temperatures within the stadium by up to 20 °C (36 °F).^{[56][57]}

Their marketing included statements describing the stadiums as zero waste, and the upper tiers of the stadiums will be disassembled after the World Cup and donated to countries with less developed sports infrastructure.^{[56][57]} Qatar aspired to be compliant and certified by the Global Sustainability Assessment System (GSAS) for all the World Cup stadiums. All of the five stadium projects launched were designed by German architect Albert Speer & Partners.^[58] The Al Bayt and Al Wakrah stadiums were the only indoor stadiums of the eight used.^[59]



Russian President Vladimir Putin handing over the symbolic relay baton for the hosting rights of the 2022 FIFA World Cup to Qatar's Emir Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani in June 2018.



Seven of the eight venues, including Lusail Stadium, the venue for the final, were new stadiums built specifically for the 2022 FIFA World Cup. The eighth was heavily renovated.

In an April 2013 report by Merrill Lynch, the organisers in Qatar requested that FIFA approve a smaller number of stadiums due to the growing costs.^[60] Bloomberg said that Qatar wished to cut the number of venues to eight or nine from the twelve originally planned.^[61] By April 2017, FIFA had yet to finalise the number of stadiums Qatar must have readied in five years' time. Qatar's Supreme Committee for Delivery and Legacy (SC) said it expected there would be eight in and near Doha, with the exception of Al Khor.^{[62][63]}



Some venues, such as the 68,000-seat Al Bayt Stadium, were planned to have their upper tiers of seating removed to reduce capacity after the tournament, however this is yet to happen.

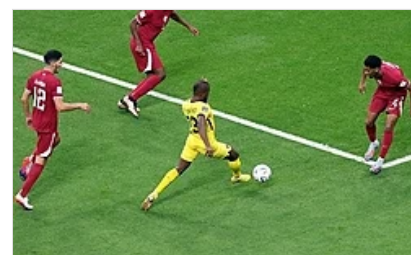
Eight stadiums in five Qatari cities were built or renovated for the FIFA World Cup. Between 2010 (when Qatar were announced as hosts) and 2022, seven of the eight stadiums were built (some in place of older, outdated venues) and the Khalifa International Stadium was renovated for the tournament.

- Al Khor: Al Bayt Stadium (new). The first piles were driven into the ground in 2014. On 30 November 2021 it hosted its first match.
- Lusail: Lusail Stadium (new). The construction of the stadium was started on 11 April 2017. It was completed on 21 November 2021.
- Al Rayyan: Ahmad bin Ali Stadium (new). The stadium was built on the demolished former stadium site. It was commissioned on 18 December 2020.
- Al Rayyan: Education City Stadium (new). It was completed on 15 June 2020.
- Al Rayyan: Khalifa International Stadium (heavily renovated). The largest stadium in the country at the time, it was closed for renovation in 2014. It was commissioned in May 2017.
- Doha: Al Thumama Stadium (new). Construction was completed on 21 October 2021.
- Doha: Stadium 974 (new). Construction commenced in 2018. It was completed on 30 November 2021 and had hosted some of the matches in 2021 FIFA Arab Cup.
- Al Wakrah: Al Janoub Stadium (new). Construction officially started in 2014 and was completed on 16 May 2019.

Of these eight stadiums, all but two have since been either dismantled, or have been moderately or heavily modified. The Stadium 974 was supposed to be dismantled after the tournament; as of November 2024 however, this has not happened and the stadium has sat abandoned in its original site—this stadium was the first planned temporary stadium ever used for a FIFA World Cup.^[64] Lusail Stadium, Al Bayt Stadium, Ahmad bin Ali Stadium, Education City Stadium, Al Thumama Stadium and Al Janoub Stadium will be moderately or heavily modified as reduce their capacity by half.^[65] The Khalifa International Stadium (latter along with the Stadium 974) are the only largely unmodified stadium that were used for this tournament.

Senegal faced Qatar in the third match of the group; Boulaye Dia capitalised on a slip by Boualem Khoukhi to put Senegal 1–0 ahead. Famara Diédhiou scored a second with a header, before Mohammed Muntari scored Qatar's first-ever goal at a World Cup to reduce the deficit back to one. Senegal eventually won the match 3–1 after an 84th-minute goal by Bamba Dieng. With this result, Qatar became the first team to be eliminated from the tournament, as well as becoming the first host nation to ever be knocked out of the tournament after two games.^[142] Gakpo scored his second goal of the tournament as the Netherlands led Ecuador; however, Valencia scored an equaliser in the 49th minute.^[143] The Netherlands won 2–0 against Qatar following goals by Gakpo and Frenkie de Jong to win the group, while Qatar attained the distinction of being the first home nation to lose all three group matches.^[144] Senegal faced Ecuador to determine the second knockout round qualifier. At the end of the first half, Ismaila Sarr scored a penalty kick to put Senegal ahead. In the 67th minute, Moisés Caicedo scored an equaliser, but shortly after, Kalidou Koulibaly gave Senegal the victory. The win was enough to qualify Senegal as the runners-up of Group A.^[145]

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Netherlands	3	2	1	0	5	1	+4	7	Advanced to knockout stage
2	Senegal	3	2	0	1	5	4	+1	6	
3	Ecuador	3	1	1	1	4	3	+1	4	
4	Qatar (H)	3	0	0	3	1	7	−6	0	



Qatar v Ecuador

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/fifaplan/en/match-centre/competition/17?date=2022-11-21&tab=competitionStandings>)

(H) Hosts

20 November 2022

Qatar 0–2 Ecuador

Al Bayt Stadium, Al Khor

21 November 2022

Senegal 0–2 Netherlands

Al Thumama Stadium, Doha

25 November 2022

Qatar 1–3 Senegal
Netherlands 1–1 Ecuador

Al Thumama Stadium, Doha
Khalifa International Stadium, Al Rayyan

29 November 2022

Ecuador 1–2 Senegal
Netherlands 2–0 Qatar

Khalifa International Stadium, Al Rayyan
Al Bayt Stadium, Al Khor

Group B

Group B began with England completing a 6–2 victory over Iran. Iranian keeper Alireza Beiranvand was removed from the game for a suspected concussion before England scored three first-half goals.^[146] Mehdi Taremi scored in the second half after which England defender Harry Maguire was also removed for a concussion.^[146] Timothy Weah, of the United States, scored a first-half goal against Wales; however, the match finished as a draw after a penalty kick was won and scored by Gareth Bale.^[147] Iran defeated Wales 2–0 following a red card to Welsh goalkeeper Wayne Hennessey after he committed a foul outside of his penalty area. Substitute Rouzbeh Cheshmi scored the first goal eight minutes into stoppage time, followed by Ramin Rezaeian scoring three minutes later.^[148] England and the United States played to a 0–0 draw, with only four shots on target between them, and one shot from Christian Pulisic hit the crossbar.^[149] England won the group following a 3–0 win over Wales with a goal by Phil Foden and two by Marcus Rashford.^[150] With the United States needing no less than a win to advance, Christian Pulisic scored the winning goal while colliding with the opposing goalkeeper as the United States defeated Iran 1–0 to qualify for the round of 16.^[151]

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	England	3	2	1	0	9	2	+7	7	Advanced to knockout stage
2	United States	3	1	2	0	2	1	+1	5	
3	Iran	3	1	0	2	4	7	−3	3	
4	Wales	3	0	1	2	1	6	−5	1	



Iran v United States

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/fifaplan/en/match-centre/competition/17?date=2022-11-21&tab=competitionStandings>)

21 November 2022

England 6–2 Iran

Khalifa International Stadium, Al Rayyan

25 November 2022	United States 	1–1	 Wales	Ahmad bin Ali Stadium, Al Rayyan
	Wales 	0–2	 Iran	Ahmad bin Ali Stadium, Al Rayyan
29 November 2022	England 	0–0	 United States	Al Bayt Stadium, Al Khor
	Wales 	0–3	 England	Ahmad bin Ali Stadium, Al Rayyan
	Iran 	0–1	 United States	Al Thumama Stadium, Doha

Group C

Argentina took an early lead against Saudi Arabia after Lionel Messi scored a penalty kick after ten minutes; however, second-half goals by Saleh Al-Shehri and Salem Al-Dawsari won the match 2–1 for Saudi Arabia,^[152] a result the media considered one of the biggest upsets in the history of the event.^{[153][154]} The match between Mexico and Poland ended as a goalless 0–0 draw after Guillermo Ochoa saved Robert Lewandowski's penalty kick attempt.^[155] Lewandowski scored his first career World Cup goal in a 2–0 win over Saudi Arabia four days later.^{[156][157]} Argentina defeated Mexico 2–0, with Messi scoring the opener and later assisting teammate Enzo Fernández who scored his first international goal.^{[158][159]} Argentina won their last game against Poland with goals from Alexis Mac Allister and Julián Álvarez, which was enough to win the group;^[160] Poland qualified for the knockout stage on goal difference, thanks to Saudi Arabia scoring an injury-time consolation goal against Mexico in a match already lost.^[161]

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Argentina	3	2	0	1	5	2	+3	6	Advanced to knockout stage
2	 Poland	3	1	1	1	2	2	0	4	
3	 Mexico	3	1	1	1	2	3	−1	4	
4	 Saudi Arabia	3	1	0	2	3	5	−2	3	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/fifaplan/en/match-centre/competition/17?date=2022-11-21&tab=competitionStandings>)



Argentina v Mexico

22 November 2022	Argentina 	1–2	 Saudi Arabia	Lusail Stadium, Lusail
	Mexico 	0–0	 Poland	Stadium 974, Doha
26 November 2022	Poland 	2–0	 Saudi Arabia	Education City Stadium, Al Rayyan
	Argentina 	2–0	 Mexico	Lusail Stadium, Lusail
30 November 2022	Poland 	0–2	 Argentina	Stadium 974, Doha
	Saudi Arabia 	1–2	 Mexico	Lusail Stadium, Lusail

Group D

The match between Denmark and Tunisia ended as a goalless draw; both teams had goals disallowed by offside calls.^[162] Danish midfielder Christian Eriksen made his first major international appearance since suffering a cardiac arrest at the UEFA Euro 2020.^[162] Defending champions France went a goal behind to Australia, after a Craig Goodwin goal within ten minutes. France, however, scored four goals, by Adrien Rabiot, Kylian Mbappé and two by Olivier Giroud to win 4–1.^[163] The goals tied Giroud with Thierry Henry as France's all-time top goalscorer.^[163] Mitchell Duke scored the only goal as Australia won against Tunisia. This was their first World Cup win since 2010.^{[164][165]} Mbappé scored a brace as France defeated Denmark 2–1. This was enough for France to qualify for the knockout round—the first time since Brazil in 2006 that the defending champions progressed through the opening round.^{[164][166]} Mathew Leckie scored the only goal as Australia defeated Denmark 1–0, qualifying for the knockout round as runners-up with the win.^[167] Wahbi Khazri scored for Tunisia against France in the 58th minute. Although Antoine Griezmann equalised in stoppage time it was overturned for offside. Tunisia finished third in the group, as they required a draw in the Denmark and Australia game.^[168]

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	France	3	2	0	1	6	3	+3	6	Advanced to knockout stage
2	Australia	3	2	0	1	3	4	-1	6	
3	Tunisia	3	1	1	1	1	1	0	4	
4	Denmark	3	0	1	2	1	3	-2	1	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/fifaplust/en/match-centre/competition/17?date=2022-11-21&tab=competitionStandings>)



France v Australia

22 November 2022

Denmark	0–0	Tunisia
France	4–1	Australia

Education City Stadium, Al Rayyan
Al Janoub Stadium, Al Wakrah

26 November 2022

Tunisia	0–1	Australia
France	2–1	Denmark

Al Janoub Stadium, Al Wakrah
Stadium 974, Doha

30 November 2022

Australia	1–0	Denmark
Tunisia	1–0	France

Al Janoub Stadium, Al Wakrah
Education City Stadium, Al Rayyan

Group E

Group E began with Japan facing 2014 champions Germany. After an early penalty kick was converted by Germany's İlkay Gündoğan, Japan scored two second-half goals by Ritsu Dōan and Takuma Asano in a 2–1 win.^[169] In the second group match, Spain defeated Costa Rica 7–0. First-half goals by Dani Olmo, Marco Asensio, and Ferran Torres were followed by goals by Gavi, Carlos Soler, Alvaro Morata, and a second by Torres.^{[170][171]} This was the largest defeat in a World Cup since Portugal's victory over North Korea in the 2010 event by the same scoreline.^[172] Costa Rica defeated Japan 1–0, with Keysher Fuller scoring with Costa Rica's first shot on target of the tournament.^[173] Germany and Spain drew 1–1, with Álvaro Morata scoring for Spain and Niclas Füllkrug scoring for Germany.^{[174][175][176]} Morata scored the opening goal for Spain against Japan as they controlled the first half of the match.^[177] Japan equalised on Ritsu Doan before a second goal by Ao Tanaka was heavily investigated by VAR for the ball potentially being out of play.^[178] The goal was awarded, and Japan won the group following a 2–1 win. Disputes over the VAR's call was only settled when the Associated Press released an iconic bird's eye photo of the ball after the match.^[178] Serge Gnabry scored on ten minutes for Germany against Costa Rica and they led until half-time. Germany required a win, and for Japan to not win their match, or for both teams to win their matches by a combined goal difference of at least 9 goals, to qualify. In the second half, goals by Yeltsin Tejeda and Juan Vargas gave Costa Rica a 2–1 lead, which would have qualified them into the knockout stages ahead of Spain. Germany scored three further goals—two by Kai Havertz and a goal by Niclas Fullkrug, ending in a 4–2 win for Germany—which was not enough to qualify them for the final stages. This was the second time in a row that the four-time champions failed to progress past the group stages.^[179] Japan won the group ahead of Spain.^[180]

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	Japan	3	2	0	1	4	3	+1	6	Advanced to knockout stage
2	Spain	3	1	1	1	9	3	+6	4	
3	Germany	3	1	1	1	6	5	+1	4	
4	Costa Rica	3	1	0	2	3	11	-8	3	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/fifaplust/en/match-centre/competition/17?date=2022-11-21&tab=competitionStandings>)



Germany v Japan

23 November 2022

Germany	1–2	Japan
Spain	7–0	Costa Rica

Khalifa International Stadium, Al Rayyan
Al Thumama Stadium, Doha

27 November 2022

Japan	0–1	Costa Rica
Spain	1–1	Germany

Ahmad bin Ali Stadium, Al Rayyan
Al Bayt Stadium, Al Khor

1 December 2022

Japan	2–1	Spain
Costa Rica	2–4	Germany

Khalifa International Stadium, Al Rayyan
Al Bayt Stadium, Al Khor

Group F

Group F's first match was a goalless draw between Morocco and Croatia.^[181] Canada had a penalty kick in the first half of their match against Belgium which was saved by Thibaut Courtois. Belgium won the match by a single goal by Michy Batshuayi.^{[182][183]} Belgium lost 2–0 to Morocco, despite Morocco having a long-range direct free kick goal by Hakim Ziyech overturned for an offside on another player in the lead up to the goal. Two second-half goals from Zakaria Aboukhlal and Romain Saïss helped the Morocco win their first World Cup match since 1998.^{[184][185]} The match sparked riots in Belgium, with fires and fireworks being set off by residents.^[186] Alphonso Davies scored Canada's first World Cup goal to give Canada the lead over Croatia. Goals by Marko Livaja, Lovro Majer, and two by Andrej Kramarić for Croatia completed a 4–1 victory.^[187] Morocco scored two early goals through Hakim Ziyech and Youssef En-Nesyri in their game against Canada and qualified following a 2–1 victory. Canada's only goal was an own goal by Nayef Aguerd.^[188] Croatia and Belgium played a goalless draw which eliminated Belgium, whose team was ranked second in the world, from the tournament.^[189]

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Morocco	3	2	1	0	4	1	+3	7	Advanced to knockout stage
2	 Croatia	3	1	2	0	4	1	+3	5	
3	 Belgium	3	1	1	1	1	2	−1	4	
4	 Canada	3	0	0	3	2	7	−5	0	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/fifaplust/en/match-centre/competition/17?date=2022-11-21&tab=competitionStandings>)



Belgium v Canada

23 November 2022

Morocco 	0–0	 Croatia
Belgium 	1–0	 Canada

Al Bayt Stadium, Al Khor
Ahmad bin Ali Stadium, Al Rayyan

27 November 2022

Belgium 	0–2	 Morocco
Croatia 	4–1	 Canada

Al Thumama Stadium, Doha
Khalifa International Stadium, Al Rayyan

1 December 2022

Croatia 	0–0	 Belgium
Canada 	1–2	 Morocco

Ahmad bin Ali Stadium, Al Rayyan
Al Thumama Stadium, Doha

Group G

Breel Embolo scored the only goal in Switzerland's 1–0 defeat of Cameroon.^[190] Richarlison scored two goals as Brazil won against Serbia, with star player Neymar receiving an ankle injury.^[191] Cameroon's Jean-Charles Castelletto scored the opening goal against Serbia, but they were quickly behind as Serbia scored three goals by Strahinja Pavlović, Sergej Milinković-Savić, and Aleksandar Mitrović either side of half time. Cameroon, however, scored goals through Vincent Aboubakar and Eric Maxim Choupo-Moting, completing a 3–3 draw.^[192] An 83rd-minute winner by Casemiro for Brazil over Switzerland was enough for them to qualify for the knockout stage.^[193] Having already qualified, Brazil were unable to win their final group game, as they were defeated by Cameroon 1–0 following a goal by Vincent Aboubakar. Already having a yellow card, he was later sent off for removing his shirt in celebrating the goal.^[194] Cameroon, however, did not qualify, as Switzerland defeated Serbia 3–2.^[195]

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Brazil	3	2	0	1	3	1	+2	6	Advanced to knockout stage
2	 Switzerland	3	2	0	1	4	3	+1	6	
3	 Cameroon	3	1	1	1	4	4	0	4	
4	 Serbia	3	0	1	2	5	8	−3	1	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/fifaplust/en/match-centre/competition/17?date=2022-11-21&tab=competitionStandings>)



Brazil v Serbia

24 November 2022

Switzerland 	1–0	 Cameroon
Brazil 	2–0	 Serbia

Al Janoub Stadium, Al Wakrah
Lusail Stadium, Lusail

28 November 2022

Cameroon 	3–3	 Serbia	Al Janoub Stadium, Al Wakrah
Brazil 	1–0	 Switzerland	Stadium 974, Doha
2 December 2022			
Serbia 	2–3	 Switzerland	Stadium 974, Doha
Cameroon 	1–0	 Brazil	Lusail Stadium, Lusail

Group H

Uruguay and South Korea played to a goalless draw.^[196] A goalless first half between Portugal and Ghana preceded a penalty converted by Cristiano Ronaldo to give Portugal the lead. In scoring the goal, Ronaldo became the first man to score in five World Cups. Ghana responded with a goal by André Ayew before goals by João Félix, and Rafael Leão by Portugal put them 3–1 ahead. Osman Bukari scored in the 89th minute to trail by a single goal, while Iñaki Williams had a chance to equalise for Ghana ten minutes into stoppage time, but slipped before shooting. The match finished 3–2 to Portugal.^[197] Ghanaian Mohammed Salisu opened the scoring against South Korea, with Mohammed Kudus following it up. In the second half, Cho Gue-sung scored a brace for South Korea, levelling the score. Mohammed Kudus scored again in the 68th minute, winning the match 3–2 for Ghana.^[198] Portugal defeated Uruguay 2–0 with two goals from Bruno Fernandes, advancing them to the knockout stage.^[199] A controversial penalty decision was called late in the game, with a suspected handball from José María Giménez.^{[200][201]} Portugal led South Korea through Ricardo Horta after 10 minutes. However, goals by Kim Young-gwon and Hwang Hee-chan won the match 2–1 for South Korea.^[202] Giorgian de Arrascaeta scored two goals as Uruguay defeated Ghana 2–0.^[203] However, with South Korea winning, Uruguay required another goal to progress as they finished third on goals scored.^[204] Several Uruguay players left the pitch after the game surrounding the referees and followed them off the pitch.^{[205][206][207]}

Pos	Team	Pld	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts	Qualification
1	 Portugal	3	2	0	1	6	4	+2	6	Advanced to knockout stage
2	 South Korea	3	1	1	1	4	4	0	4	
3	 Uruguay	3	1	1	1	2	2	0	4	
4	 Ghana	3	1	0	2	5	7	–2	3	

Source: FIFA (<https://www.fifa.com/fifaplust/en/match-centre/competition/17?date=2022-11-21&tab=competitionStandings>)



Portugal v Uruguay

24 November 2022

Uruguay 	0–0	 South Korea	Education City Stadium, Al Rayyan
Portugal 	3–2	 Ghana	Stadium 974, Doha

28 November 2022

South Korea 	2–3	 Ghana	Education City Stadium, Al Rayyan
Portugal 	2–0	 Uruguay	Lusail Stadium, Lusail

2 December 2022

Ghana 	0–2	 Uruguay	Al Janoub Stadium, Al Wakrah
South Korea 	2–1	 Portugal	Education City Stadium, Al Rayyan

Knockout stage

In the knockout stage, if the scores were equal when normal playing time expired, extra time was played for two periods of 15 minutes each. This was followed, if required, by a penalty shoot-out to determine the winners.^[133]

Bracket

Round of 16	Quarter-finals	Semi-finals	Final
3 December – Al Rayyan (KIS)  Netherlands 3  United States 1 3 December – Al Rayyan (ABAS)  Argentina 2  Australia 1 5 December – Al Wakrah  Japan 1 (1)	9 December – Lusail  Netherlands 2 (3)  Argentina (p) 2 (4) 9 December – Al Rayyan (ECS)  Croatia 0	13 December – Lusail  Argentina 3  Croatia 0	

Quarter-finals

The quarter-finals were played on 9 and 10 December.^[32] Croatia and Brazil ended 0–0 after 90 minutes and went to extra time. Neymar scored for Brazil in the 15th minute of extra time. Croatia, however, equalised through [Bruno Petković](#) in the second period of extra time. With the match tied, a penalty shootout decided the contest, with Croatia winning the shootout 4–2.^{[217][218]} In the second quarter-final match, [Nahuel Molina](#) and Messi scored for Argentina before [Wout Weghorst](#) equalised with two goals shortly before the end of the game. The match went to extra time and then penalties, where Argentina would go on to win 4–3.^[219] Morocco defeated Portugal 1–0, with [Youssef En-Nesyri](#) scoring at the end of the first half. Morocco became the first African and the first Arab nation to advance as far as the semi-finals of the competition.^[220] Despite [Harry Kane](#) scoring a penalty for England, it was not enough to beat France, who won 2–1 by virtue of goals from [Aurélien Tchouaméni](#) and [Olivier Giroud](#) and a late missed penalty by Kane, sending them to their second consecutive World Cup semi-final and becoming the first defending champions to reach this stage since Brazil in 1998.^{[221][222]}

9 December 2022
18:00

Croatia 	1–1 (a.e.t.) [Report 9]	Brazil 
Petković ⚽ 117'		Neymar ⚽ 105+1'
Penalties	4–2	
Vlašić 		 Rodrygo
Majer 		 Casemiro
Modrić 		 Pedro
Oršić 		 Marquinhos

[Education City Stadium](#), [Al Rayyan](#)
Attendance: 43,893
Referee: [Michael Oliver](#) (England)

9 December 2022
22:00

Netherlands 	2–2 (a.e.t.) [Report 10]	Argentina 
Weghorst ⚽ 83', 90+11'		Molina ⚽ 35'
		Messi ⚽ 73' (pen.)
Penalties	3–4	
Van Dijk 		 Messi
Berghuis 		 Paredes
Koopmeiners 		 Montiel
Weghorst 		 Fernández
L. de Jong 		 La. Martínez

[Lusail Stadium](#), [Lusail](#)
Attendance: 88,235
Referee: [Antonio Mateu Lahoz](#) (Spain)

10 December 2022
18:00

Morocco 	1–0 [Report 11]	Portugal 
En-Nesyri ⚽ 42'		

[Al Thumama Stadium](#), [Doha](#)
Attendance: 44,198
Referee: [Facundo Tello](#) (Argentina)

10 December 2022
22:00

England 	1–2 [Report 12]	France 
Kane ⚽ 54' (pen.)		Tchouaméni ⚽ 17'
		Giroud ⚽ 78'

[Al Bayt Stadium](#), [Al Khor](#)
Attendance: 68,895
Referee: [Wilton Sampaio](#) (Brazil)

Semi-finals

The semi-finals were played on 13 and 14 December.^[32] Messi scored a penalty kick before Julián Álvarez scored twice to give Argentina a 3–0 victory over Croatia.^[223] Théo Hernandez scored after five minutes as France led Morocco for most of the game. Randal Kolo Muani scored in the 78th minute to complete a 2–0 victory for France over Morocco as they reached their second consecutive final.^[224]

13 December 2022
22:00

Argentina 	3–0 ^[Report 13]	 Croatia
Messi ⚽ 34' (pen.) Álvarez ⚽ 39', 69'		

Lusail Stadium, Lusail
Attendance: 88,966
Referee: Daniele Orsato (Italy)

14 December 2022
22:00

France 	2–0 ^[Report 14]	 Morocco
T. Hernandez ⚽ 5' Kolo Muani ⚽ 79'		

Al Bayt Stadium, Al Khor
Attendance: 68,294
Referee: César Arturo Ramos (Mexico)

Match for third place

The match for third place was played on 17 December. The two teams had played against each other in their opening game in Group F which finished 0–0. Joško Gvardiol promptly scored for Croatia, with Achraf Dari equalising just 2 minutes later. Mislav Oršić scored the winner for Croatia as the match finished 2–1.^[225] Morocco earned 4th place, a record for the team and the best World Cup finish of any African or Arab nation.^[226]

17 December 2022
18:00

Croatia 	2–1 ^[Report 15]	 Morocco
Gvardiol ⚽ 7' Oršić ⚽ 42'		Dari ⚽ 9'

Khalifa International Stadium, Al Rayyan
Attendance: 44,137
Referee: Abdulrahman Al-Jassim (Qatar)

Final

The final was played on 18 December between Argentina and France. Both teams had won the event twice previously.^[227] Early goals from Lionel Messi and Ángel Di María gave Argentina a 2–0 lead against the French.^{[227][228]} Despite substitutions in the first half, France did not record a shot until after the 70th minute but were energised by additional substitutions in the 71st. A few minutes later, France were awarded a penalty as Randal Kolo Muani was brought down in the penalty area by Nicolás Otamendi. Mbappé scored the penalty and added a second goal less than two minutes later to equalise the scores.^[228] With the score tied at two goals apiece, the match went to extra time. Messi scored his second goal in the 108th minute, once again giving Argentina the lead. However, Mbappé was awarded a second penalty in the 115th minute after his shot hit the arm of Gonzalo Montiel. Mbappé scored his third goal, becoming the second player ever to complete a hat-trick in the final of a World Cup after Geoff Hurst for England in 1966.^[228] With the score tied at 3–3, the match was determined via a penalty shootout. Argentina won the final after scoring all of their penalties, winning 4–2.^[228] This marked their third World Cup win and their first since 1986, and also the second team (after Spain in 2010) to win the tournament after having lost their opening game.^[228]

18 December 2022
18:00

Argentina 	3–3 (a.e.t.)	 France
--	---------------------	---

Due to Qatar's laws on alcohol consumption, World Cup organisers announced the creation of designated "sobering-up" zones as an alternative to wide-scale arrests of intoxicated fans during the World Cup.^[323] Qatar's World Cup chief executive of the Supreme Committee for Delivery and Legacy, Nasser Al Khater, stated that the purpose of the designated sobering-up areas was to ensure the fans' safety.^[324] If a fan was sent to the "sobering up" zone, they were permitted to leave when they could display clearheaded behaviour.^[325] Multiple news agencies described the controversy as a "cultural clash" between social conservatism and Islamic morality against the "norms" of secular Western liberal democracies.^{[11][326]}

A number of groups and media outlets expressed concern over the suitability of Qatar to host the event.^{[327][328]} Issues ranged from human rights,^{[8][300]} worker conditions, the rights of LGBT fans,^[300] and the illegality of homosexuality in Qatar.^{[329][330][331]} In December 2020, Qatar said rainbow flags would be allowed at the 2022 FIFA World Cup.^[332] Qatari officials initially stated that they would not prohibit the display of pride flags at tournament venues, although the country still advised LGBT attendees to comply with the country's modesty and avoid public displays of affection.^{[333][334]} Hassan Abdulla al-Thawadi, chief executive of the country's World Cup bid, said that Qatar would permit alcohol consumption during the event,^{[335][336]} even though drinking in public was not permitted.^[337] There were plans to allow the sale of alcohol inside stadiums and at fan villages.^[338] Normally, the sale of alcohol is restricted to non-Muslim guests at selected luxury hotels only.^[339] However, in the months preceding the tournament, the display of LGBT material and the sale of alcohol were banned.^{[338][340][341][342][343]}

The climate conditions caused some to call hosting the tournament in Qatar infeasible, with initial plans for air-conditioned stadiums giving way to a potential date switch from summer to November and December.^[5] In May 2014, Sepp Blatter, who was FIFA president at the time of the selection, remarked that awarding the World Cup to Qatar was a "mistake" because of the extreme heat.^{[5][344][345]} While addressing delegates from African and Asian confederations, Blatter said allegations of corruption and some of the criticism, including those from sponsors, were "very much linked to racism and discrimination".^[346] The attendance figures at the matches also came under scrutiny as the reported crowd attendance was more than the stadium capacities despite games having visible empty seats.^[347]

Prior to the tournament, a reporter for Denmark's TV 2 was threatened by security during a live report from the Katara Cultural Village; the organising committee apologised, stating that they were "mistakenly interrupted".^[348] Tony O'Donoghue of Ireland's RTÉ also accused Qatari police of interrupting him while filming.^[349]

Phaedra Almajid, a former media officer for Qatar's 2022 World Cup bid, has alleged that three African football officials were offered bribes to support Qatar's bid. In a Netflix documentary series "FIFA Uncovered," Almajid claims that Hassan Al Thawadi, who led Qatar's bid, offered €2.3 million each to Issa Hayatou of Cameroon, Jacques Anouma of Ivory Coast, and Amos Adamu of Nigeria in exchange for their votes. Qatar was competing with Australia, Japan, South Korea and the US for their bid for the 2022 World Cup. The alleged offer was made during a meeting of African football federations in January 2010. Almajid states that the money was intended for the football federations, not as personal bribes. She initially disclosed these allegations anonymously to the Sunday Times after being dismissed from her position, but later retracted her claims, citing threats from Qatar. Al Thawadi has denied these allegations, calling them false and expressing disappointment at the situation. The controversy adds to the ongoing scrutiny surrounding Qatar's successful bid to host the 2022 World Cup.^[350]

Targeted hacking campaigns against critics

On 2 November 2022, Swiss media outlet SRF Investigativ published an investigative piece about Qatar's elaborate and extensive espionage operation to secure the World Cup hosting rights. The operation, which was dubbed Project Merciless, involved hacking emails and phones of FIFA officials and critics of Qatar's corruption and poor human rights record. It also targeted their friends and family members to run smear campaigns and influence FIFA policy. Starting on 5 January 2012, a cyberattack targeted Peter Hargitay, a Zurich-based FIFA insider and consultant for Australia's 2022 World Cup bid. Hargitay and his son hired an expert who traced the hack to a server linked to Rajat Khare of the mercenary Indian hack-for-hire firm Appin.^{[351][352][353][354]} In November 2022, a lower court in Geneva ordered the publication to provisionally remove Rajat Khare's name and photo from the article.^[355] As a result, he is currently referred to as an entrepreneur, though his name still appears in a Reuters article about his involvement in the hacking.^[356]

On 5 November 2022, The Sunday Times and the Bureau of Investigative Journalism published an investigation reporting that a group from an Indian hacking company had compromised the email accounts of various politicians, reporters, and other prominent individuals that had been critical of Qatar's hosting of the World Cup. It was also reported that the group had been hired by Jonas Rey, private investigators based in Switzerland, which were in turn hired by Qatari officials.^[357]

Migrant workers

There was criticism regarding the state of human rights in Qatar and of the conditions of migrant workers brought in to build the required infrastructure, including indentured servitude and working conditions leading to deaths.^[361] On 23 October 2022, an article published by *The Guardian* included statements from migrants working on the event infrastructure. Surveying 1,000 workers, 86% of participants said that the labour changes had improved their lives and that better working conditions are negotiable.^[362] Legislation has also been proposed on the minimum wage, summertime worker safety, and the election of migrant worker representatives in businesses. Labour mobility is a result of changes to the Kafala system.^[363]

According to Sharan Burrow, general secretary of the International Trade Union Confederation, prior to the tournament, "the new Kafala system tranche of law will put an end to Kafala and establish a contemporary industrial relations system."^[364]

FIFA President Gianni Infantino has defended Qatar's decision to host the tournament.^[365] *The Economist* has asserted that Qatar has a better human rights record than Russia and China, and that the country has received excessive criticism after being selected to host the event.^[366]

Move to November and December

Owing to the climate in Qatar, concerns were expressed over holding the World Cup in its traditional time frame of June and July.^[5] In October 2013, a task force was commissioned to consider alternative dates and report after the 2014 FIFA World Cup in Brazil.^[367] On 24 February 2015, the FIFA Task Force proposed that the tournament be played from late November to late December 2022,^[368] to avoid the summer heat and also avoid clashing with the 2022 Winter Olympics in February, the 2022 Winter Paralympics in March and Ramadan in April.^{[369][370]}

The notion of staging the tournament in November was controversial because it would interfere with the regular season schedules of some domestic leagues around the world. Commentators noted the clash with the Christian Christmas season was likely to cause disruption, while there was concern about how short the tournament was intended to be.^[371] FIFA executive committee member Theo Zwanziger said that awarding the event to Qatar was a "blatant mistake".^[372]

Frank Lowy, chairman of Football Federation Australia, said that if the 2022 World Cup were moved to November and thus upset the schedule of the A-League, they would seek compensation from FIFA.^[373] Richard Scudamore, chief executive of the Premier League, stated that they would consider legal action against FIFA because a move would interfere with the Premier League's popular Christmas and New Year fixture programme.^[374] In 2015, FIFA confirmed that the final would be played in December.^[375] Critics condemned the Euro-centrism of these allegations, and questioned why global sporting events must be held within the traditional European summer season.^[376]

Bidding corruption allegations, 2014

Some allegations were made over the role of former football official Mohammed bin Hammam played in securing the bid.^[377] A former employee of the Qatar bid team alleged that several African officials were paid \$1.5 million by Qatar.^[378] She retracted her claims, but later said that she was coerced to do so by Qatari bid officials.^{[379][380]} In March 2014, it was discovered that former CONCACAF president Jack Warner and his family were paid almost \$2 million from a firm linked to Qatar's successful campaign.^[381]

The Sunday Times published bribery allegations based on a leak of millions of secret documents.^[382] Five of FIFA's six primary sponsors, Sony, Adidas, Visa, Hyundai, and Coca-Cola, called upon FIFA to investigate the claims.^{[383][384]} Jim Boyce, vice-president of FIFA, stated he would support a re-vote to find a new host if the corruption allegations are proven.^{[385][386]} FIFA completed a lengthy investigation into these allegations and a report cleared Qatar of any wrongdoing. Despite the claims, the Qataris insisted that the corruption allegations were being driven by envy and mistrust while Blatter said it was fuelled by racism in the British media.^{[387][388]}

In the 2015 FIFA corruption case, Swiss officials, operating under information from the United States Department of Justice, arrested many senior FIFA officials in Zürich and seized physical and electronic records from FIFA's main headquarters. The arrests continued in the United States, where several FIFA officers were arrested, and FIFA buildings were raided. The arrests were made on the information of at least a \$150 million corruption and bribery scandal.^[389] From those arrested, \$40 million was forfeited under guilty pleas.^[390] In 2022, the president of the El Salvador soccer association, Reynaldo Vasquez, was sentenced to 16 months in prison in connection to over \$350,000 in bribes.^[391]

Following the corruption case, Phaedra Almajid, the former media officer for the Qatar bid team, claimed that the allegations would result in Qatar not hosting the World Cup.^[392] In an interview published on the same day, Domenico Scala, the head of FIFA's Audit and Compliance Committee, stated that "should there be evidence that the awards to Qatar and Russia came only because of bought votes, then the awards could be cancelled."^{[393][394]}

In 2014, FIFA appointed Michael Garcia as its independent ethics investigator to look into bribery allegations against Russia and Qatar. Garcia investigated all nine bids and eleven countries involved in the 2018 and 2022 bids.^[395] At the end of the investigation, Garcia submitted a 430-page report. The FIFA governing body then appointed a German judge, Hans Joachim Eckert, who reviewed and presented a 42-page summary of the report two months later. The report cleared Qatar and Russia of bribery allegations, stating that Qatar "pulled Aspire into the orbit of the bid in significant ways" but did not "compromise the integrity" of the overall bid process.^[396] Michael Garcia reacted almost immediately, stating that the report is "materially incomplete" and contains "erroneous representations of the facts and conclusions".^[396]

In 2017, a German journalist Peter Rossberg claimed to have obtained the report and wrote that it "does not provide proof that the 2018 or 2022 World Cup was bought" and stated that he would publish the full report. This forced FIFA to release the original report. The full report did not provide any evidence of corruption against the host of the 2022 World Cup but stated that bidders tested the rules of conduct to the limit.^[397]

Russian participation

On 9 December 2019, the World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA) handed Russia a four-year ban from all major sporting events, after RUSADA was found non-compliant for handing over manipulated lab data to investigators.^[398] The Russian national team were still permitted to enter qualification, as the ban only applied to the final tournament to decide the world champions. A team representing Russia, which used the Russian flag and anthem, could not participate under the WADA decision whilst the ban was active.^[399] The decision was appealed to the Court of Arbitration for Sport,^[400] and on 17 December 2020, Russian teams were banned from competing at world championships organised or sanctioned by a WADA signatory until 16 December 2022, the day before the match for third place.^[401]

After the Russian invasion of Ukraine, Russia's participation was further thrown into doubt. On 24 February 2022, the three teams in Russia's qualifying path—Czech Republic, Poland, and Sweden—announced their unwillingness to play any matches in Russian territory.^[402] Poland and Sweden extended the boycott on 26 February to any qualifying games, and the Czech Republic made the same decision one day later.^{[403][404][405]}

On 27 February 2022, FIFA announced a number of sanctions impacting Russia's participation in international football. Russia was prohibited from hosting international competitions, and the national team was ordered to play all home matches behind closed doors in neutral countries. Under these sanctions, Russia would not be allowed to compete under the country's name, flag, or national anthem; similarly to the Russian athletes' participation in events such as the Olympics,^[406] the team would compete under the abbreviation of their national federation, the Russian Football Union ("RFU"), rather than "Russia".^[407] The next day, FIFA decided to suspend Russia from international competitions "until further notice", including its participation in the 2022 FIFA World Cup.^[408]

LGBTQ and women's rights

There are no LGBTQ rights in Qatar, with homosexuality as well as campaigning for LGBTQ+ rights criminalised. As such, when Qatar was selected to host the 2022 FIFA World Cup, the choice to do so in a restrictive nation saw much criticism, with the security of fans,^[409] as well as the homophobic football chants of certain nations, were points of discussion.^[410] The main controversy came from a last-minute FIFA decision to hand out player punishments to European captains who had months earlier announced their intention to continue wearing rainbow-coloured armbands (which began in 2020) in support of anti-discrimination. Typically, kit violations incur a fine, which the teams had said they would pay; on the day of the first match involving one of the teams, FIFA reportedly told the teams that they would receive a yellow card at a minimum for wearing the armbands.^[411] Qatari officials stated that all people are welcome as long as they follow the public display of affection laws which apply to everyone.^{[412][413]}

Security officials at stadiums also confiscated items of rainbow clothing and flags featuring rainbows.^{[414][415]} American journalist Grant Wahl was briefly detained for wearing a T-shirt with a rainbow on it.^[416] Wahl reportedly received death threats for wearing the shirt, later dying at the stadium.^{[417][418]} Other journalists with Wahl at the time of his death have reported that he began fitting or experiencing a seizure, and called for help himself. They criticised the Qatar Supreme Committee for not providing

defibrillators in the stadium, as they had looked for one to try to help Wahl.^[419] In response, FIFA said that according to the ambulance service, a defibrillator was made available when paramedics later arrived on scene.^[420] An autopsy done on Wahl in New York City later revealed that Wahl died from an aortic aneurysm rupture.^[421]

Discrimination against women in Qatar was also criticised.^{[422][423]} Women in Qatar have few freedoms,^{[422][424]} as they must obtain permission from their male guardians to marry, study abroad on government scholarships, work in many government jobs, travel abroad, receive certain forms of reproductive health care, and act as the primary guardian of children, even if they are divorced.^[425]

Qatar attracted particular criticism for an incident where a Mexican employee of the World Cup Organizing Committee was accused of allegedly having sex outside of marriage. The woman had previously reported rape, while the male claimed to have been in a relationship with her, after which the woman was investigated for extramarital sex. Women in Qatar face the possible penalty of flagellation and a seven-year prison sentence if convicted for having sex outside of marriage. The criminal case was eventually dropped months after she was allowed to leave Qatar.^[426]

Influence of Iran

In November 2022, there were reports suggesting that the government of Iran were working with Qatari officials to suppress anti-government protests at the 2022 FIFA World Cup,^[427] in light of the Mahsa Amini protests. Leaked documents and audio clips suggested that Iranian government officials were in correspondence with Qatari authorities in order to handle possible protesters.^[428]

In November 2022, the Qatari government revoked the visas of journalists from a London-based Iranian news channel, Iran International, known for being critical of the regime, who were seeking to cover the World Cup.^[429] On 21 November 2022, during the first group stage match from Group B, between Iran and England, attempts were reportedly made by the stadium's security forces to block Iranian fans who wore clothing or carried items bearing slogans that were deemed unsympathetic to the Islamic government of Iran.^[430] These included T-shirts and signs with "Woman, Life, Freedom" embedded onto them, Iran's previous flags such as the Lion and Sun flag, or any slogans containing the name of Mahsa Amini.^[431] This crackdown continued throughout all of Iran's matches at the World Cup.^[427] In addition to removing fans from stadiums, reports showed that officials tried to suppress any filming or photography of possible protests. In one case, Qatari police detained Danish TV presenter, Rasmus Tantholdt, for filming fans with "Woman, Life, Freedom" slogans, some of whom who had been earlier abused by a group of pro-government supporters.^[432]



An Iranian fan showing a banner with "Woman, Life, Freedom" slogan.

Treatment of Jewish and Israeli visitors

Qatar had previously promised to provide Jewish tourists with cooked kosher food and public Jewish prayer services at the tournament. However, shortly before the World Cup began, both were banned by Qatar, who claimed it could not secure the safety of Jews.^{[433][434]} Qatar alleged that they could not "secure" the safety of publicly praying Jewish tourists, whilst many foreign Jews complained that they subsequently had no food available to eat. It was estimated that 10,000 religious Jews from Israel and around the world arrived to watch the World Cup in Qatar.^[435]

Whilst Jewish organisations complained of being unable to find cooked kosher food,^[435] the Israeli government said it was happy with the efforts made by Qatar to meet its requests, including kosher food, direct flights from Israel to Qatar, and temporary diplomatic representation in the country. A kosher kitchen under the supervision of Rabbi Mendy Chitrik was open in time for the first match. Rabbi Marc Schneier, president of The Foundation for Ethnic Understanding, said he had never asked the Qatari government for cooked food, and he had been the only person in communication with the Qataris regarding making the World Cup experience inclusive for Jews.^[436]

Multiple Israeli reporters at the tournament reported fans from Arab nations waving Palestinian flags and chanting anti-Israeli slogans while harassing them.^{[300][437][438]} Some Israelis reported that they had been escorted out of restaurants when their nationality was revealed.^[439] The Israeli government warned its citizens traveling to the tournament to hide their Israeli identity out of safety concerns.^[440]